

Philipp Hilbert. *Founding product manager for AI-native operational platforms.*

Positioning, ten years translating complex operational workflows into shipped software, now ready to do exactly that for an agentic AI platform from day one.

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Dear SODA team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role because the problem you are solving – automating complex operational workflows through an AI-native platform – is exactly what I have spent the past several years doing in production. Not advising on it, not roadmapping around it: writing the user stories, sitting beside engineers while they build, and rolling features to live environments.

At Rohde & Schwarz, inside the European defence programme FCAS, I owned an AI and data management platform for multimodal datasets. I delivered feature sets end-to-end – user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps rollout via ArgoCD – and single-handedly unblocked an infrastructure issue that had been open for over a year, delivering in one week what engineers had not. At Emil Group, I inherited a broken B2B InsurTech delivery organisation, restructured a bloated seventeen-person team into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops in what was still a prototype-stage environment. At the Federal Employment Agency I shipped a public labour market analytics platform, introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipelines, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer – all simultaneously.

What I bring to an early-stage AI company is the combination of deep technical fluency and customer-facing discovery instinct that the job description asks for. I can read a Kubernetes manifest, design an agentic workflow in n8n, and then sit in a customer interview the same afternoon to validate whether the workflow I just designed solves an actual pain or an assumed one. I use Claude, GPT, Lovable, and Cursor daily – not as productivity add-ons but as the primary surface through which I write specs, prototype interfaces, and generate edge cases. I have built my own multi-agent orchestration framework and a crypto backtesting engine as personal infrastructure projects, which is the clearest signal I can offer that this interest is structural rather than fashionable.

The role description explicitly says this is not a roadmap management position. That is reassuring rather than alarming to me. The work I find energising is precisely the upstream part: finding the real problem, designing the smallest test of a solution, getting that test in front of a user before engineering has written a line, and then driving the delivery once the bet is validated. I am also a native German speaker, which the listing flags as a nice-to-have, and I am already in Berlin.

I would welcome a conversation about the specific workflow problems your customers are bringing to you and how I can help turn those into product.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
